Table 2.1 Distance of the planets from the sun

Name Of The Planet	Mercury	Venus	Earth	Mars	Jupiter	Saturn	Uranus	Neptune
Diameter (km)	4,879	12,104	12,756	6,794	1,42,984	1,20,536	51,118	49,528
Density (kg/m3)	5,427	5,243	5,514	3,933	1,326	687	1,271	1,638
Rotation Period (hours)	1,407.6	5,832.5	23.9	24.6	9.9	10.7	17.2	16.1
Length of Day (hours)	4,222.6	2,802	24	24.7	9.9	10.7	17.2	16.1
The Average distance from the sun(10^6 km)	57.9	108.2	149.6	227.9	778.6	1,433.5	2,872.5	4,495.1
Orbital Period (days)	88	224.7	365.3	687	4331	10,747	30,589	59,800
Number of Satellites	0	0	1	2	67	53	27	13

The Earth

Earth is the third nearest planet to the sun. It is the fifth largest planet in the solar system. The Earth's orbit lies between the orbits of Venus and Mars. It takes 23 hours 56 minutes and 4 seconds for the earth to complete one rotation on its own axis. The Earth takes 365.25 days (Table 2.1) to complete one revolution around the Sun. Earth's surface temperature varies from – 88°C to 58°C and it is the densest planet in the solar system.

The Earth is a unique planet because of its distance from the sun, its motions, atmosphere with oxygen, presence of water and moderate temperature. The earth is neither too close nor too far from the sun. It is the only known planet to support life. It is also known as the **'Blue Planet'** because of the presence of water. Earth has only one natural satellite called the Moon. The sun light takes about 8.2 minutes to reach the earth.

The Mars

Mars is the fourth nearest planet to the sun and it is the second smallest planet in the Solar system. It is also described as the **"Red planet"**. It is reddish in colour due to the presence of iron oxide on its surface. The landmass of Mars and Earth are very similar. It takes 24 hours and 37 minutes to complete one rotation on its axis and its takes 687 days to complete one revolution around the Sun. The surface temperature of the Mars is ranging from -153°C to 20°C. With the exception of the Earth, Mars probably is the most hospitable to life. This planet has seasons, polar ice caps, volcanoes, canyons and weather. Mars has two satellites namely Phobos and Deimos.

The Jupiter

Jupiter is the largest planet in the solar system. It is fifth planet from the sun. It is made primarily of gases and is therefore known as **'Giant Gas planet'**. It takes 9 hours 55 minutes to complete one rotation on its axis and it takes 11.86 years to complete one revolution. Jupiter has the shortest day in the solar system. Jupiter has a faint ring system around it. They are mostly comprised of dust particles. Jupiter has 67 confirmed satellites orbiting the planet. Ganymede, the satellite of Jupiter, is the largest natural satellite in the solar system (even bigger than the planet Mercury).

The Saturn

Saturn is the sixth planet from the sun and the second largest planet in the solar

TN_Govt_Geography_XI_Std Unit_02.indd 29 15-12-2021 16:37:08